

5. Do you live within your means? Y/N
6. Do you make debt repayment a priority? Y/N
7. If you have children, do you have a plan in place to save for their education? Y/N
8. If you're planning to buy a house, are you saving for a sufficient down payment (at least 20 percent)? Y/N
9. Do you cultivate good habits—such as bringing lunch to work and using libraries—with the express purpose of saving money? Y/N
10. Do you have money set aside in case of emergencies? Y/N

ON INVESTING

1. Are you ready to invest? Y/N
2. Do you have a clear understanding of your retirement goals? Y/N
3. Do you understand your appetite for risk? Y/N
4. Do you have working knowledge of the various financial products available to you, from stocks to bonds to treasuries to mutual funds, and the difference between yield, nonyield, dividend- and non-dividend-paying products? Y/N
5. Do you have a pension plan? Y/N
6. Do you understand retirement vehicles—IRAs, 401(k)s—and their attendant tax benefits? Y/N
7. Do you work with a trusted financial advisor who helps you navigate complicated investing vehicles? Y/N
8. Do you pay attention to financial news on a regular basis? Y/N
9. Do you invest only in things you understand? Y/N?
10. Do you react to volatile markets with moderation and patience? Y/N

If you answered yes to most of these questions, kudos to you. I hope this book reinforces some of your good spending, saving, and investment habits and helps you avoid forming bad ones.